

Dhāraṇī of the Noble Avalokiteśvara

Āryāvalokiteśvaradhāraṇī · Toh 695 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྐྱུ་རས་གཟགིས་ཀྱི་བྱང་པའི་གཟུངས།

Toh 695 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text known in Tibetan as Phags pa Spyān ras gzigs kyi dbang po'i rig pa, and in Sanskrit is associated with a vidyā of the noble Avalokiteśvara. The text belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and centers on a powerful mantra or vidyā devoted to Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva of compassion, whose name appears in both the opening homage and the body of the text. It opens with salutations to the Three Jewels and to Avalokiteśvara himself before presenting the vidyā in full, along with a description of its benefits — most notably the power to recall past lives across hundreds and thousands of rebirths. As is typical of dhāraṇī literature, the text is brief and liturgically oriented, intended for recitation and the practical attainment of spiritual and meritorious results.

Homage to the Buddha. Homage to the Dharma. Homage to the Saṅgha.
Homage to the noble Avalokiteśvara, lord of bodhisattvas, great being.

Having paid homage to these, recite this vidyā: may this vidyā be accomplished in me.

Tadyathā: ha ha ha sa ne ni pa sa ne, ta pa ta pa ne, jvala jvala ne, cala cala ne, pūrva yoga smara padma hastāya svāhā.

Whoever recites this vidyā will recall their births through hundreds and thousands of lifetimes. And when they pass from this world and are reborn,

Translator's Notes

- The term "vidyā" is used here in the sense of a knowledge-mantra or dhāraṇī spell; the Tibetan "rig pa" in this ritual context specifically means "vidyā" (a feminine mantra or knowledge-spell) rather than "awareness" or "rigpa" in the contemplative sense. The text breaks off mid-sentence ("And when they pass from this world and are reborn") as the passage provided is incomplete.

Colophon

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translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.